

Ophir Mineral Ventures, Inc.

A compliance-forward, owner-manageable corporate website for a Philippine nickel & chromite ore exporter — plan, architecture, security, deployment and cost, prepared for internal review before presenting to the owner.

PREPARED FOR	SUBJECT	STATUS	DATE
Internal review (pre-client)	John David Montilla, Owner	Draft – pending client input	2026-08-06

01 Research findings

What's publicly verifiable about the company today, and what that implies for the site.

SIGNAL	Finding
Existing website	None found. No domain, no indexed site. Confirms the greenfield build.
Sector	Mineral ore mining/trading — nickel ore and chromite ore exports, sourced in the Philippines.
Trade activity (2025)	6 recorded export shipments, ~58.3 million kg total, single shipments valued from ~\$146K to ~\$39.86M.
Buyers	100% of recorded trading partners are China-based (incl. Beijing Jiuda Hantang Trading, Tianjin Impaliva, Value Gain Development HK).

Registration / permits	Not publicly discoverable (SEC-PH, DENR-MGB permit databases returned no indexed record). Not unusual — these registries are not fully searchable by the public. Must be sourced directly from the client.
John David Montilla	No verifiable public profile matched with confidence. We deliberately did not try to cross-reference personal records — that's a conversation to have directly with him, not a research task.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR THE BRIEF

Because every buyer we can see is China-based, and single shipments run into the tens of millions of dollars, this site has a second, quieter job beyond "compliance": it's **due-diligence collateral**. Overseas buyers and their banks routinely vet counterparties online before wiring large sums. A thin, generic, or template-obvious site is itself a red flag in that process. A credible one accelerates deals.

NON-OBVIOUS RECOMMENDATION

Given the 100%-China buyer concentration, a **bilingual English / Simplified Chinese (中文)** toggle on the key commercial pages (About, Products, Certifications, Contact) is a stronger marketing lever here than almost anything else on this list — it directly serves the audience actually closing deals. Flagged in the roadmap (\$11) rather than v1 scope, since it depends on John's appetite and translation budget.

02 What John means by "Google host"

Untangling three different Google products that get mentally lumped together — plus what's actually true in 2026.

John almost certainly means **Google Workspace** — the paid product that gives him professional email like `john@ophirmineralventures.com` running on Gmail's infrastructure, plus Drive, Calendar and Docs. It is *not* a website product, even though Google bundles a very basic one inside it. Here's the full picture:

PRODUCT	WHAT IT ACTUALLY IS	RELEVANT HERE?

Google Workspace	Paid subscription (\$7–\$22/user/month, annual) for business email on your own domain via Gmail, plus Drive/Calendar/Meet/Docs. This is what John pays for.	KEEP AS-IS
Google Sites	A free, very basic drag-and-drop website builder bundled inside Workspace. Produces the generic-looking "template" sites John is reacting against. Not a CMS in any real sense — no plugins, no real SEO control, no custom design.	DO NOT USE
Google Domains	Google's old domain registrar. Shut down and fully migrated to Squarespace Domains in 2024 — if John registered his domain through Google before that, it now lives in a Squarespace account, not a Google one.	Check where the domain actually lives now
Google Business Profile	Free listing that makes the company show up on Google Maps/local search. Separate from all of the above, and something we want regardless.	SET UP IN LAUNCH PHASE

How the email part technically works

A domain's DNS zone is just a set of routing rules. Two record types matter here, and they can point to two completely different services without conflict:

- **MX records** — tell the internet "mail for this domain goes to Google's mail servers." This is what makes Workspace email work, and it is completely independent of what the website runs on.
- **A / CNAME records** — tell browsers "the website for this domain lives at this server." This is what we control when we build the new site.

Practical upshot: **we can build a fully custom website and deploy it without touching John's email at all.** The MX records stay exactly as they are; only the website-facing records change. Diagram in §04 makes this concrete.

ACTION FOR THE DISCOVERY CALL

Ask John: (1) which domain registrar he logs into today — Google, Squarespace, or something else, (2) whether he wants to keep paying for Workspace email (recommended: yes, don't touch it), and (3) whether anyone ever built a Google Site for the business that's quietly live somewhere.

03 Goals, audiences & requirements

Product framing before any design or stack decision.

Primary goals, in priority order

1. **Compliance & credibility** — a legitimate, verifiable public presence for regulators, banks, and counterparties running due diligence.
2. **Marketing & deal-closing** — professional collateral John can point buyers to instead of a WhatsApp number and a trade-directory listing.
3. **Owner independence** — John edits text, swaps photos, and adds a news update himself; a developer is only needed for structural changes.

Audiences

Overseas buyers & their compliance teams

Chinese trading houses and smelters vetting a new or existing supplier before wire transfer. Want: proof of legitimacy, product specs, contact clarity.

Philippine regulators & banks

SEC, DENR-MGB, AMLA-covered banks handling large USD/RMB transfers. Want: registered name, permits, transparent ownership.

Local stakeholders & partners

LGUs, community, logistics/shipping partners, potential JV partners. Want: legitimacy, operations overview, contact.

John (the owner)

Non-developer, needs to self-serve content changes. Want: a CMS he can actually drive without calling anyone.

Non-negotiable requirements

- ☐ Owner can edit text/images/PDFs without writing code or calling a developer
- ☐ Loads fast and reads credibly on mobile — most Chinese buyer-side contacts will open a WhatsApp-shared link on a phone

- ☐ HTTPS, hardened admin access, offsite backups from day one
- ☐ Doesn't touch or risk the existing Workspace email
- ☐ Indexable by Google/Bing (and therefore Yahoo — see §07)
- ☐ Data Privacy Act (RA 10173) compliant contact form and privacy policy

04 Sitemap & content plan

v1 scope — every row below is something the owner edits without a developer once the templates exist.

PAGE	PURPOSE	OWNER-EDITABLE CONTENT
Home	First impression, credibility signal, routes traffic	Hero text/photo, headline stats, featured news
About / Company Profile	Who Ophir Mineral Ventures is; owner bio	History, mission, leadership bios & photos
Products (Nickel Ore, Chromite Ore)	B2B spec sheet for buyers	Grade/spec tables, photos, downloadable spec PDF
Compliance & Certifications	The core "compliance" ask — SEC, DTI, BIR, DENR-MGB permits	Certificate images/PDFs, registration numbers, renewal dates
Sustainability / ESG	Environmental & community practices — increasingly expected by buyers' compliance teams	Short narrative, photos, initiatives list
News / Updates	Freshness signal for SEO; shipment/award milestones	Blog-style posts, unlimited
Contact	Lead capture, routes inquiries by type	Form fields, address, map, WhatsApp/phone
Privacy Policy / Terms	Legal — Data Privacy Act compliance	Rarely changes; still owner-editable

Careers, an investor-relations section, and a buyer RFQ portal are deliberately deferred — see the roadmap (§11).

05 Technical architecture

Optimized for one constraint above all others: John must be able to run this without a developer on speed-dial.

REVISION — V1.1

v1 of this plan recommended WordPress, weighted mainly toward "anyone could pick this up later." That's the wrong primary criterion — the brief was a stack *you* already know and can run without leaning on AI or learning a new language. Revised below: **Umbraco**, a self-hosted, open-source CMS built on ASP.NET Core/C#. Same non-technical editing experience for John, zero new language for you.

OPTION	OWNER CAN SELF-EDIT?	FITS YOUR EXISTING SKILLS?	SECURITY SURFACE	COST
Umbraco CMS (ASP.NET Core / C#, self-hosted)	Yes — polished, purpose-built non-technical backoffice	Yes — pure C# and Razor, the same Visual Studio/.NET tooling you already use daily; SQLite or SQL Server, your call	Moderate-low — .NET's default output encoding and anti-forgery protections, a small dependency surface, and you wire the CSP/security headers yourself in middleware	~\$500
WordPress + page-builder theme, managed hosting	Yes, mature, huge tutorial base	No — PHP/MySQL ecosystem, a different debugging mental model, plugin updates you'd be trusting rather than reading	Moderate — mitigated by managed host + WAF, but plugin sprawl is WordPress's classic weak point	~\$1000

All-in-one
builder
(Webflow /
Wix /
Squarespace)

Yes, easiest
onboarding

No — proprietary visual
builder, no code at all to
"maintain"

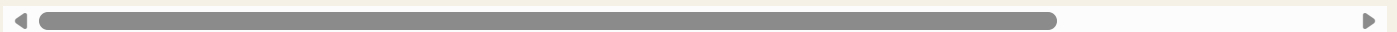
Low (vendor-
managed)

~\$2

Recommendation: self-hosted Umbraco on ASP.NET Core, deployed the way you'd deploy any of your own .NET projects — Git repo, GitHub Actions, push to a host. John gets a content tree and a block-based page editor comparable to WordPress's; you get a codebase in a language you can read, extend, and secure yourself, with no PHP and no need to loop in AI to make sense of someone else's plugin. It's also genuinely custom — no theme-marketplace look to fight against.

Why Umbraco, not a hand-rolled ASP.NET Core app

You could build the whole thing yourself in plain ASP.NET Core MVC/Razor Pages with a hand-rolled admin panel — for a single-page brochure site that's a legitimate shortcut. Umbraco earns its place the moment John needs to add pages, reorder sections, or publish a news post *without you*: it gives him that editing surface for free, while every template, content type, and block is still C#/Razor you write and fully understand — not a black box.



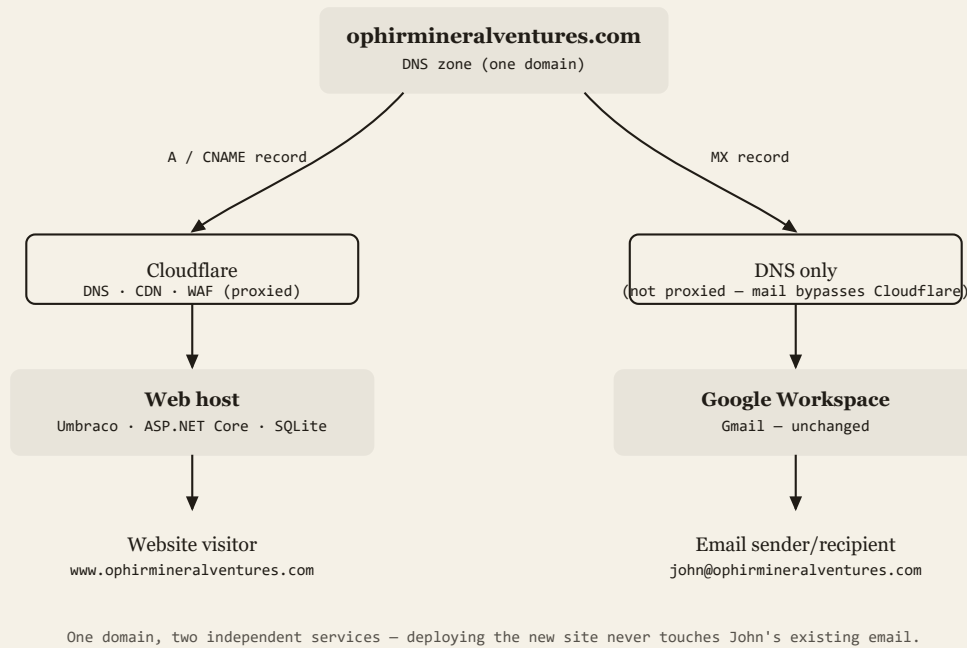


Fig. 1 — The DNS zone is the only thing the website and the email have in common. Website traffic and mail traffic are routed by different record types to different providers, so the two projects can't interfere with each other.

Component list

Umbraco 18 (open source, self-hosted)

ASP.NET Core on .NET 10

SQLite (or Azure SQL if you want managed backups)

Azure App Service or a budget ASP.NET host (e.g. SmarterASP.NET)

Cloudflare Free – DNS, CDN, WAF

Hand-rolled contact form (Razor + SMTP/SendGrid) – no paid forms plugin

Custom SEO fields + sitemap.xml – built by you, not a plugin

GitHub Actions → deploy – same CI/CD workflow as your other projects

Google Analytics 4 + Search Console

Google Workspace – email (untouched)

Proportionate to what this site actually is: a public marketing/compliance surface, not a system of record. No customer accounts, no payments, no sensitive data at rest beyond contact-form submissions.

Transport & headers

Forced HTTPS + HSTS; Content-Security-Policy, X-Frame-Options, Referrer-Policy and Permissions-Policy headers set directly in ASP.NET Core middleware — code you write and own, not a plugin default.

Admin hardening

2FA on the Umbraco backoffice, unique strong passwords, login-attempt limiting, no default admin username.

Patching & surface area

Security patches applied via NuGet package updates on your own schedule, not silently auto-applied; minimal dependency count; a staging slot for testing updates before they hit production.

Backups

3-2-1 pattern: host-level daily backup + a scheduled export of the database/media to offsite storage (Azure Blob or Google Drive), restore-tested periodically.

Data Privacy Act (RA 10173)

Published privacy policy, explicit consent checkbox on the contact form, minimal PII retention, no third-party trackers beyond GA4 without disclosure.

Role separation

John gets an "Editor" role — full content control, no ability to break plugins/theme/settings. An "Administrator" role stays with whoever maintains the site.

07 Getting found: Google, Bing & Yahoo

The useful shortcut: Yahoo Search has run on Bing's index since 2015. Covering Google and Bing covers effectively the whole market, including Yahoo and DuckDuckGo.

1. **Technical baseline** — HTTPS, one canonical domain (www vs non-www decided once), XML sitemap, clean robots.txt, mobile-first responsive layout, fast load

times (Core Web Vitals is a ranking factor).

2. **Submit to both consoles** — Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools, each pointed at the sitemap. Free, takes under an hour, and Bing Webmaster Tools covers Yahoo automatically.
3. **Google Business Profile** — free local listing; puts the company on Google Maps and the local pack for searches like "nickel ore exporter Philippines."
4. **On-page SEO** — unique title/meta description per page, real header hierarchy, descriptive image alt text, Organization + LocalBusiness JSON-LD schema markup.
5. **Off-page signals** — get the existing trade-directory listings (Trademo, 52wmb) and any Philippine Chamber of Mines / export-association directories linking back to the new official domain.
6. **Freshness** — the News/Updates page (§04) exists specifically to give search engines a reason to recrawl regularly.

Paid Google/Bing Ads are optional and out of v1 scope — worth a separate, small budget later if John wants inbound lead volume rather than relying on referral/direct.

08 Deployment plan

Six phases, roughly six weeks end-to-end assuming timely content/approvals from the client — the usual bottleneck on projects like this is waiting on logos, photos and certificate copies, not the build itself.

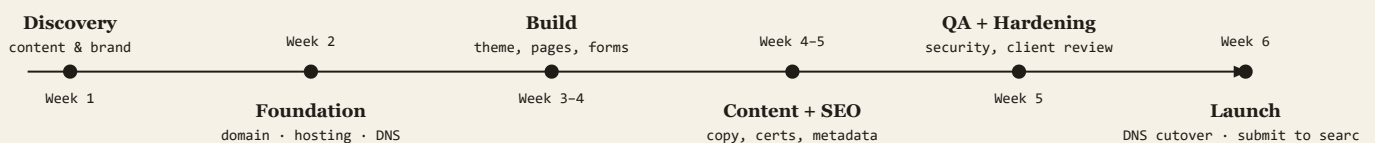


Fig. 2 — Deployment phases. Content/approval turnaround from the client is the typical schedule risk, not the technical build.

PHASE	KEY STEPS
0 · Discovery	Confirm domain/registrars situation, gather logo, brand colors, real operation photos, permit/certificate copies, finalize sitemap with John
1 · Foundation	Register/redirect domain, provision hosting (Azure App Service or a budget ASP.NET host), configure Cloudflare, scaffold the Umbraco solution + baseline security headers
2 · Build	Build Umbraco document types + Razor templates for every row in §04, build the contact form and its routing, set up the content tree for John
3 · Content & SEO	Populate real copy/images, write meta titles/descriptions, add schema markup, generate sitemap.xml
4 · QA & hardening	Cross-browser/mobile QA, run a security header + backup check, client walkthrough and sign-off, brief John using the editor guide (§09)
5 · Launch	Point A/CNAME record live, verify email untouched, submit sitemap to Google Search Console + Bing Webmaster Tools, create Google Business Profile
6 · Post-launch (ongoing)	Monthly plugin/core updates, quarterly backup-restore test, review analytics, add news posts

09 Cost plan

USD, two tiers. Development labor is excluded (assumed self-built) — this is purely the recurring infrastructure/licensing bill John should expect.

Year 1 — one-time + first year

ITEM	LEAN MVP	RECOMMENDED	NOTES
Domain (.com)	\$15	\$15	Or ~\$40–60 for a .com.ph if local trust signaling matters. Verisign wholesale rises 2026-11-01
ASP.NET hosting	\$60	\$158	Lean: SmarterASP.NET Advance ~\$4.95/mo (Basic \$2.95), .NET 10.x supported, no renewal

			hike. Recommended: Azure App Service B1 Linux \$13.14/mo, with a staging slot
Database	\$0	\$59	Lean: SQLite, embedded, no server to manage. Recommended: Azure SQL Basic \$4.90/mo for managed backups/scale
Cloudflare (DNS/CDN/WAF)	\$0	\$0	Free plan is sufficient at this traffic scale
Contact form + email delivery	\$0	\$0	Hand-built in Razor + SendGrid free tier (100 emails/day) — no paid forms plugin needed
SEO tooling	\$0	\$0	Meta fields, schema markup and sitemap.xml are hand-built, not a paid plugin
Monitoring	\$0	\$0	Azure Application Insights free tier covers this traffic volume
Stock photos / branding polish	\$0	\$150	Real operations photos from John are strongly preferred over stock either way
Google Workspace email	\$84	\$84	Already paid by John — Business Starter, 1 user, annual. Unaffected by this project.
Year 1 total (excl. existing email)	~\$75	~\$382	

Year 2+ recurring

ITEM	LEAN MVP	RECOMMENDED
Domain renewal	\$15	\$15
Hosting renewal	\$60	\$158
Database	\$0	\$59
Annual total	~\$75	~\$232

WHY THIS IS CHEAPER THAN THE WORDPRESS PATH

No recurring plugin licenses. Forms, SEO fields, and security headers are small enough that you'll write and own them directly in C#/Razor rather than paying an annual fee to a plugin author for something

WordPress can't do out of the box. That's a direct, ongoing cost benefit of building this on a stack you actually control.

READING THIS TABLE

Either tier is inexpensive relative to the shipment values in §01 — this is not where John should be cost-sensitive. The Recommended tier buys real staging/backup safety nets and design flexibility; the Lean tier is a legitimate way to launch fast and upgrade later without rebuilding anything.

10 Maintainability & governance

- **Editor guide** — a short, plain-language one-pager for John: how to edit a page, swap a photo, publish a news post, and who to call if something looks broken. This is the single highest-leverage deliverable for "less developer intervention."
 - **Roles** — John: Editor role (content only). Developer/maintainer: Administrator (structure, plugins, security).
 - **Staging site** — every plugin/theme update tested on staging before production, so a bad update never takes the live site down mid-negotiation with a buyer.
 - **Update cadence** — monthly core/plugin updates, quarterly full review (broken links, outdated certs, stale stats), yearly domain/hosting renewal check.
 - **Why this stack, restated** — Umbraco was chosen so you can maintain, extend, and secure this site with skills you already have: no PHP, no plugin roulette, no need to loop in AI to understand someone else's code. As a secondary benefit, Umbraco has the largest .NET CMS talent pool of any option evaluated, so handing off maintenance later is still realistic — it just isn't the reason for the pick.
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11 Roadmap — deferred, not forgotten

Bilingual EN / 中文

Highest-leverage addition given the buyer base (\$01). WPML or Polylang once core content is stable.

Careers page

Add once hiring becomes a recurring need.

Investor-relations section

If John ever seeks outside capital or a JV partner.

Buyer RFQ portal

Structured quote-request flow instead of a generic contact form, once inbound volume justifies it.

CRM integration

Route contact-form leads into a free-tier CRM (HubSpot Free) once John wants pipeline tracking.

Headless mode

Revisit if traffic/complexity ever outgrows a monolithic CMS — Umbraco can run headless behind a separate front-end without leaving the .NET ecosystem.

12 Open questions for John

Needed before or during Discovery (\$08, Phase 0) — nothing here should be guessed or scraped.

- ☐ Preferred domain name, and where the current one (if any) is registered
- ☐ Legal company details to publish: SEC registration number, business address, TIN/BIR details as he wants them shown
- ☐ Which permits/certifications he wants public (DENR-MGB, ECC, others) and current copies of each

- ☐ Logo and brand assets — or confirmation that we're designing a wordmark from scratch
- ☐ Real photos: operations, ore samples, leadership — stock photography undercuts the credibility goal
- ☐ How he wants his own bio/role presented on the About page
- ☐ Appetite for a bilingual Chinese version (\$11) and translation budget
- ☐ Confirmation on keeping existing Google Workspace email as-is (\$02)

Ophir Mineral Ventures – Website Plan & Architecture · Draft v1.1 · Revised 2026-08-06 ·
Pair with the homepage design draft before presenting to the client.